MWCF Board, Wednesday: your briefing

Built from the papers in your Drive: the November Operational Overview (Máiréad, 6 Nov), the September and October minutes, the Location Sub-committee notes (4 Nov), the Gemini notes of the 5 Nov call, and the Chairperson's governance documents (4 Nov). Where a paper does not say something, this sheet says so. Gemini notes are machine-written and contain errors.

1. The meeting

- **When and where:** Wed 11 Nov at 16:00 (your note; the pack gives no time). No venue in any paper: earlier meetings were in the Support Centre Conference Room. **Confirm the venue with Máiréad.** Chair: John Lawler. Secretary: Ann-Marie Gilmartin. Treasurer: Martina Somers. No formal agenda is in the folder.
- **Likely order:** declarations of interest; **your 10 minutes, very close to the start** (Gemini 5 Nov); Lawler's "day in the life" presentation; Máiréad's Operational Overview (impact, HR, facilities, finance, events, wish list, priorities); governance, strategy and location; group photo (postponed from October).
- **For decision:** a cleaning team at 216 euro a month; four governance drafts awaiting approval (independent-advice procedure with a draft cap of 500 euro per matter and an annual budget, sub-committee policy, skills questionnaire, and the Comms Plan, whose WhatsApp group follows Board approval). No vote is scheduled on location; the 5 Nov group deferred setting a relocation date until after this meeting.
- **You speak for about 10 minutes** on engagement to date and your views on property. Lawler said no slides are needed; there is a big screen if you want one.

2. The numbers (Operational Overview; provisional)

Item	Figure
Clients 1 Jan to 31 Oct	411 (109 male, 302 female): 311 directly affected, 33 spouse or partner, 67 family or carer. 58 new in October.
Sessions	1,662 one-to-ones: reflexology 831, counselling 405, Reiki 169, massage 150, Indian head massage 82, facials 25.
Year to date (31 Oct)	Income 305,315.08; direct costs 66,664.84; operating costs 172,644.93; profit 66,005.31. Two unlabelled bank balances: 193,172.36 and 100,998.00.
October v projection	Income 50,019.31 v 19,336.30 (+30,683.01). Operating costs 20,328.34 v 16,337.58 (over by 3,990.77; two laptops and client-room furniture). October income included HSE 36,000 and 11,137.88 of donations and fundraisers.

- **Caution:** finance is marked "update to follow on 10/11 following internal financial review" (I read that as 10 Nov). There is no year-to-date budget, no reserves figure or policy and no cash-flow forecast in the pack. The October beat may be an HSE catch-up (the October minutes say 33,000 was expected); that is my inference.
- The location table adds up to 408, not 411 (17 records unclassified, matching the 17 error or duplicate records Máiréad described). Limerick 69%, Clare 15%, Tipperary 9%, Cork 2%.
- Events: Strand Hotel evening Wed 9 Dec, 7pm, speakers to be confirmed. A 1,200 euro NCW GAA Cards night donation is coming for a fridge.

3. Actions

Open from September and October	Status
Governance plan (Lawler)	Drafts issued 4 Nov; tracker shows 1 of 16 actions complete.
Mission Statement (Toland, Máiréad)	**Conflict:** the October minutes say still in progress; the governance pack says "agreed 21 Oct".
Referral-source data (Máiréad)	**Not in the pack.**
Monthly financials in the Board's format	Partly done; update due 10 Nov.
HSE and 2027 location (Gilmartin)	No update. Five months of tenancy were left at 21 Oct.
Outreach plan starting with a pilot	Agreed in October but no named owner.
San Martino, shared services, ARC merger	"Agreed to revisit"; open.

Yours (from 5 Nov): write to Joe about St Joseph's (you said 6 Nov; status unknown); engage Gordon Kearney; chase the council and Mayor's office on Mon 9 Nov and update Lawler and Máiréad before Wednesday; prepare your 10 minutes; skills questionnaire back by 27 Nov; sign the acknowledgement, the Information Pack acceptance and a declaration of interests.

4. Property

- **Current premises:** Mungret College since July 2025. The October minutes say five months left at 21 Oct; you told the Mayor's office on 5 Nov it runs "until early in the new year". **Align the end date and any renewal option before you speak.**
- **The Board is divided** (October minutes): some dispute that the current site is unfit (park, parking, staff goodwill); several prefer developing San Martino; they dislike shared services such as a primary-care centre and oppose an ARC merger ("agreed to revisit").
- **The 5 Nov group** (Lawler, Máiréad, you): current site judged unsuitable (draughts, no running water or dishwasher, no private meeting room, storage, steps); planning baseline about 5,000 sq ft plus, not the 8-room limit; vacant crèche units rejected (change of use needs planning and a business case); relocation date deferred until after Wednesday.
- **Council civic building, Dooradoyle:** ground floor for 2 to 3 years; your email asked for an indication before 11 Nov; next contact is Jane Lehy, head of property; top floor already leased. You said you could be in within two weeks if there was a deal. Verbal only, unconfirmed.

- **HSE or primary care route:** Edward Street and a possible nearby site; Joe in Galway for St Joseph's; you said 3 to 6 months at best and nothing this side of Christmas. Joe's surname is masked in the notes, so "Joe Hoare" is not confirmed by these papers.
- **McManus:** Lawler's account of the funder's position is verbal; the 5 Nov group discussed a formal approach with the target model. Nothing is in writing and the minutes do not record it.
- **San Marino site:** pre-planning ref 1044365, no application lodged; parking and Birch Grove access risks stand; no price, title or sale position in any paper. **Check:** the council's 1,030 sqm is about 11,100 sq ft; ask whether that is floor or site area, because it changes how San Marino compares with the 5,000 sq ft target.
- **Not in any paper:** the outreach pilot site and who decides it, and a property budget.

5. Governance pack (4 Nov): what you must do

- **Sign and return** the Constitution and Mission Statement acknowledgement (due 4 Nov; tracker shows overdue); sign the Information Pack acceptance; complete the skills questionnaire by 27 Nov (the Chair compiles the matrix by 4 Dec).
- **Constitution file** is only a covering note, form and receipt log; neither the Constitution text nor the Mission wording is in it, and your name is missing from the receipt log.
- **Comms Plan:** monthly pack at least 3 days before the meeting (finance is late against that); fortnightly Friday update from 6 Nov; WhatsApp only for informal use, never confidential matters; four points still open.
- **Information Pack:** you are a director (Companies Act s228) and a charity trustee; declare conflicts, leave the room, do not vote; strict confidentiality; no individual binds the Foundation. Many placeholders remain; it still lists Sandra Cooney as Administrator.
- **Tracker:** 6% complete (1 of 16), four drafts awaiting approval, the 21 Oct meeting log is blank. The skills form has "property and facilities" and a "New Building" sub-committee option: you are the obvious fit.

6. Questions to ask

1. When does full finance arrive? Is October's beat a one-off HSE catch-up? What are the YTD budget, reserves and the two bank balances for?
2. Where is the referral data the Board asked for in October?
3. Does the Board authorise the property pursuit, including the approach to the Mayor's office, the HSE, Gordon Kearney and a formal approach to McManus, and can that be minuted? Who else may speak for the Foundation on property?
4. What is the one deciding reason San Marino is dropped, and what would reverse it? Have those preferring San Martino seen the parking and access issues and the McManus condition?
5. What is the tenancy end date and renewal position, and the interim plan if council space fails?
6. Were Breda's new fundraising role and the third October hire approved, and what do they cost?
7. Which draft governance papers are voted on today? What is the 216 euro cleaning authority?
8. Does Rooney Auctioneers have a conflict if it acts on a sale or letting? Declare any interest of your own if a candidate site touches your contacts.

If you have 30 minutes: Operational Overview pp2 to 5 (10); October minutes items 4 to 7 (5); the Gemini "Next steps" and transcript 00:11 to 00:44 (8); tracker summary and skills questionnaire (4); notes for your 10 minutes (3). Do not repeat the private, candid remarks about the Board made on the 5 Nov call.